

Taste and Other Tales

Roald Dahl - Penguin Readers

Taste | The Leg of Lamb | The Way Up to Heaven | Mrs. Bixby and the Colonel's Coat

1. READING COMPREHENSION

Story 1: TASTE

1. What is the main character's profession? What makes him feel proud?
2. What is the bet about? What are the stakes?
3. How does the story show the character's confidence?
4. What is the outcome of the bet? Is the main character's pride justified?
5. What is Dahl's message about arrogance and expertise?

Story 2: THE LEG OF LAMB

1. Why does Mary Maloney kill her husband Patrick?
2. How does she murder him? What is the murder weapon?
3. What is clever about her plan to hide the evidence?
4. What do the police officers do that is ironic?
5. Why is the ending so shocking and funny at the same time?

Story 3: THE WAY UP TO HEAVEN

1. How long have the Fosters been married? Do you think they are happy together?
2. What is Mrs. Foster's small habit that annoys Mr. Foster?
3. What does Mrs. Foster do while she is in Paris?
4. What happens to Mr. Foster while she is away?
5. Why is it ironic that the story is called "The Way Up to Heaven"?

Story 4: MRS BIXBY AND THE COLONEL'S COAT

1. Who is the Colonel? What is Mrs. Bixby to him?
2. What gift does the Colonel give to Mrs. Bixby?
3. How much does the coat cost? How does Mrs. Bixby feel about it?
4. What does her husband Cyril do with the coat?
5. How does Mrs. Bixby react when she sees her husband's secretary?

2. VOCABULARY MATCHING - KEY WORDS FROM STORIES

Word	Definition
1. Arrogant	A. A piece of clothing worn on the shoulders
2. Coat	B. The skill or knowledge about something
3. Expertise	C. Proud and believing you are better than others
4. Irritating	D. To kill someone
5. Murder	E. Annoying
6. Deceive	F. To delay doing something
7. Procastinate	G. Harm done to someone as pay-back for wrong
8. Revenge	H. To trick or mislead someone

Answers: 1-___, 2-___, 3-___, 4-___, 5-___, 6-___, 7-___, 8-___

3. VOCABULARY - COMPLETE THE SENTENCES

Use words from the word bank: **confident, cunning, furious, clever, cruel, annoyed, bored, suspicious**

1. The man in "Taste" was very _____ that he could identify any wine.
2. Mary Maloney was _____ with her husband and plotted revenge.
3. Mrs. Foster was _____ in her marriage and wanted to escape.
4. Mr. Foster felt _____ by his wife's constant delays.
5. Mrs. Bixby came up with a _____ plan to punish her husband.
6. Mary's idea to hide the murder weapon was very _____.
7. The man in "Taste" was _____ when he realized he had lost the bet.
8. Mr. Cyril Bixby became _____ about the expensive coat.

4. CHARACTER ANALYSIS - MATCHING CHARACTERS TO DESCRIPTIONS

Character	Description
1. The man in "Taste"	A. A woman unhappy in her marriage, secretly has a lover
2. Mary Maloney	B. A proud wine expert who loses a bet
3. Mrs. Foster	C. A husband who mistreats his wife but gets what he deserves
4. Mr. Foster	D. A military officer who gives a valuable gift
5. Mrs. Bixby	E. A pregnant woman who murders her husband
6. Cyril Bixby	F. An old, impatient man who hates waiting
7. The Colonel	G. A woman who gets revenge on her husband

5. TRUE OR FALSE - WITH CORRECTIONS

1. **"Taste"** - The main character correctly identifies all the wines and wins the bet.

True / False

Correction: _____

2. **"The Leg of Lamb"** - Mary Maloney is immediately arrested by the police.

True / False

Correction: _____

3. **"The Way Up to Heaven"** - Mrs. Foster travels to Paris with her husband.

True / False

Correction: _____

4. **"Mrs. Bixby and the Colonel's Coat"** - The coat is a gift for Mrs. Bixby from her husband.

True / False

Correction: _____

5. **"The Leg of Lamb"** - The murder weapon is found by the police at the crime scene.

True / False

Correction: _____

6. **"Mrs. Bixby and the Colonel's Coat"** - Mrs. Bixby goes to the pawnbroker's shop to get the coat back.

True / False

Correction: _____

6. SEQUENCING - PUT EVENTS IN ORDER

"The Leg of Lamb" - Put these events in the correct order (1-5):

- ___ The police arrive and ask questions.
- ___ Mary Maloney cooks the leg of lamb.
- ___ Patrick tells Mary he is leaving her.
- ___ Mary hits Patrick with the frozen lamb.
- ___ The police eat the evidence.

"The Way Up to Heaven" - Put these events in the correct order (1-4):

- ___ Mrs. Foster sees her letters on the floor.
- ___ Mr. Foster gets stuck in the elevator and dies.
- ___ Mrs. Foster goes to Paris for a month.
- ___ The couple argues about missing the flight.

7. GRAMMAR - PAST TENSE COMPLETION

1. When the man _____ (taste) the wine, he _____ (feel) very confident.
2. While Mary _____ (prepare) dinner, her husband _____ (announce) that he _____ (leave) her.
3. When Mrs. Foster _____ (get) into the elevator, Mr. Foster _____ (press) the button.
4. When the Colonel _____ (give) Mrs. Bixby the coat, she _____ (not know) what her husband _____ (do).
5. While the police _____ (investigate) the crime, they _____ (eat) the murder weapon.
6. When Mrs. Bixby _____ (discover) the truth about the coat, she _____ (be) angry but also amused.

8. GRAMMAR - CONNECTORS AND TRANSITIONS

Complete the sentences with appropriate connectors: **However, Although, Because, Therefore, While, As soon as, Despite.**

1. **"Taste":** The man was very proud, _____, he was actually a fool.
2. **"The Leg of Lamb":** _____ Mary was pregnant, she was strong enough to murder her husband.
3. **"The Way Up to Heaven":** _____ her husband was arrogant and impatient, Mrs. Foster decided to leave.
4. **"The Leg of Lamb":** The police officers checked the house, _____ the fact they didn't suspect Mary.

9. THEMATIC ANALYSIS - MATCH STORIES TO THEMES

Story	Theme
1. Taste	A. Infidelity and revenge
2. The Leg of Lamb	B. The consequences of arrogance
3. The Way Up to Heaven	C. Marriage problems and escape
4. Mrs. Bixby and the Colonel's Coat	D. Domestic violence and sweet justice

Answers: 1-____, 2-____, 3-____, 4-____

10. IRONY IN DAHL'S STORIES

Irony = When something happens that is the OPPOSITE of what we expect.

1. **"Taste"** - What is ironic about the ending?

2. **"The Leg of Lamb"** - What is ironic about how the evidence disappears?

3. **"The Way Up to Heaven"** - Why is the title ironic?

4. **"Mrs Bixby and the Colonel's Coat"** - What is the final irony?

11. COMPREHENSION - SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS

1. Why is Mary Maloney's plan so clever in "The Leg of Lamb"?

2. How does Mr. Foster's death serve as justice in "The Way Up to Heaven"?

3. What does the coat represent in "Mrs. Bixby and the Colonel's Coat"?

4. Why do you think Dahl wrote stories about people getting revenge?

12. DISCUSSION QUESTIONS - CHOOSE ONE

Option A: Justice and Revenge

- Do you think the characters deserve what happens to them in these stories?
- Is revenge ever justified? Explain your answer with examples.
- What is the difference between justice and revenge?

Option B: Relationships and Marriage

- What do these stories tell us about marriage and relationships?
- Why are the marriages in these stories unhappy?
- Would you describe any of these characters as victims or villains?

Option C: Dahl's Writing Style

- How does Dahl use dark humor in these stories?
- Which story is the most shocking? Why?
- What makes the endings of Dahl's stories so memorable?

Your Answer (choose one option and answer with 5-7 sentences):

13. WRITING ACTIVITY - REWRITE AN ENDING

Choose ONE story and rewrite the ending (80-100 words). Be creative and make it different from the original!

Story you choose: _____

Original ending (Write a 1-sentence summary):

My new ending:

14. WRITING ACTIVITY - CHARACTER DIARY ENTRY

Choose ONE character and write a diary entry from their perspective (100-150 words). Write about their feelings and what they did.

Character: _____

Date: _____

Dear Diary,

15. CREATIVE WRITING - WHAT HAPPENS NEXT?

Choose ONE story and continue the story with what you think happens after it ends (100-120 words).

Story: _____

What happens next?

ANSWER KEY & TEACHER'S GUIDE

Exercise 2 - Vocabulary Matching:

1-C, 2-A, 3-B, 4-E, 5-D, 6-H, 7-F, 8-G

Exercise 3 - Word Completion:

1. confident, 2. furious, 3. bored, 4. trapped, 5. clever, 6. cunning, 7. furious, 8. suspicious

Exercise 7 - True/False:

1. False
2. False
3. False
4. False
5. False
6. False